

Groww, for your first ₹100

Redesigning Groww for 20–26 year-old, first-time investors in India

My take on the problem

Access is solved. Groww already opens an account in minutes, and **56% of new NSE investors are now under 30**. The problem is what happens *after* the account opens.

A 22-year-old arrives with a small, irregular income, a finfluencer feed, and no idea which of 1,000+ funds is "right". The app greets them with tickers, red/green P&L and F&O one tap away. So they **freeze** (empty account) or **gamble**: SEBI found **91% of F&O traders lost money in FY25**, and 89% of under-30 traders lost. Both end in churn and broken trust.

The real job: **turn an anxious first-timer into someone with a lasting habit, and get them through their first dip**. For Groww, that's the most valuable customer there is: one who joins at 22 and stays 30 years.

The psychology I designed around:

- **Present bias**. "Retirement" feels abstract; Goa in March doesn't. → *Start from goals*.
- **Lumpy money**. A missed fixed SIP feels like failure. → *Flexible by default*.
- **Loss aversion peaks at the first red number**. → *Calm by default, context during dips*.
- **Jargon causes shame**. People don't ask; they leave. → *Explain every term where it appears*.
- **Apps and reels run on dopamine**. → *Reward consistency, not activity*.
- **Social matters, but comparison is toxic**. → *Share progress %, never amounts*.

In scope

- Onboarding from "who are you" to a starter plan and the first ₹100 (KYC assumed done)
- Goal-based **Stashes**, with the fund picked automatically from the time horizon
- Payday split, weekly SIPs, skip/pause, step-up, and streaks with "freezes"
- Calm mode, Dip Coach, and a panic-sell check
- 60-second **Bytes** (story lessons) and a tap-to-decode jargon dictionary
- Guardrails: F&O reality check, quiz, cool-off, loss limit; single-stock concentration warning
- Squads, brand-led stock discovery, dark mode

Out of scope

- **KYC/account opening**: already strong on Groww
- **Real payments, live prices, order routing**: data is illustrative
- **Credit, BNPL, loans**: pushing debt on first earners works against the goal
- **Crypto**: unregulated in India
- **F&O trading screens and paper trading**: only the gate is designed
- **Hinglish/vernacular**: copy is kept translatable; localisation is next
- **Tax, US stocks, personalised advice**: advice needs SEBI RIA registration

The solution: goal-first, calm-by-default Groww

1. **Ask "what's it for?", not "what to buy?"** Each goal becomes a Stash. The time horizon picks the bucket (Steady / Balanced / Growth) and says why. Money needed within 2 years never goes into equity. Earners get an emergency cushion first. Unaffordable goals become an honest first milestone, not a 2034 deadline.
2. **Fit the money people actually have**. ₹100 minimum. A one-tap **payday split** for salaries; gig and pocket money get a % of each payment. Skip or pause with no penalty. Streaks count *weeks invested*, not trades, with freezes for broke months.
3. **Calm by default**. Home shows goal progress, not today's P&L (peek any time). In a dip, **Dip Coach** explains what moved and what usually happens next. Selling long-term money gets one neutral check; short-term money is never intercepted.
4. **Learn without leaving**. Every jargon word is tappable. Bytes teach in 60 seconds, story-style, ending with one quick question.
5. **Friction only where it protects**. F&O shows SEBI's loss data, a 3-question check, a one-time 24-hour cool-off and a self-set loss limit; a capped Spice pot gives risk-seekers room. It still unlocks.
6. **Social, without comparison**. Squads let friends save for the same trip and see each other's % progress, never rupees.

Why this: it targets the two biggest churn points, *the empty account* and *the first dip*. And the first win (₹100 invested, a celebration, week 1 of the streak) lands within **12 taps** of opening the app.

How I'd measure it. North star: % of new 20–26 users with ≥3 contributions by day 90. Guardrails: F&O activation within 30 days (↓), redemptions during dips (↓), SIP bounce rate (↓), D90 retention (↑).

Assumptions. KYC is done; Groww UPI AutoPay handles mandates; funds, returns and prices are illustrative; stats are from SEBI's FY25 F&O study and NSE investor data.

Links: [App](#) · [Evals](#)